CONNEXUS black sea tech forum | 2026

Foundations, incidents & responses

(Navigating murky waters)



ICT CLUSTER VARNA

BSMEPA
BULGARIAN SMALL AND MEDIUM ENTERPRISES PROMOTION AGENCY

ВАРНА

BRAIN++ AI FACTORY

ARC FUND

FOUNDATIONS

(aka: basis, pillars, underpinning, bedrock, cornerstone, …)



22.07.2026 @ 05h30

FOUNDATIONS



- So you gave your kids (a) smartphone(s)
- Did you also give them guidance on how-to-use-it?
- Really?





FOUNDATIONS
(data input)

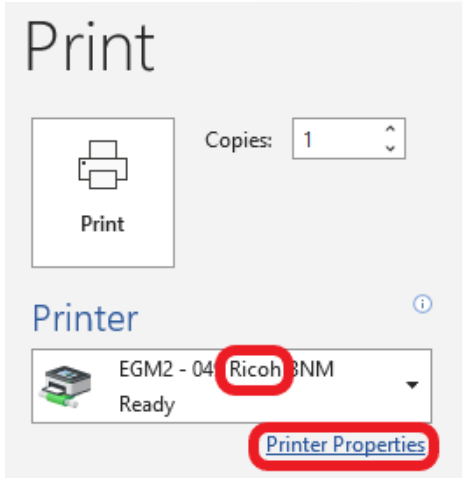
Teach yourself to type with 10 fingers !
(after all, you use both hands/10 fingers when rowing/playing piano)

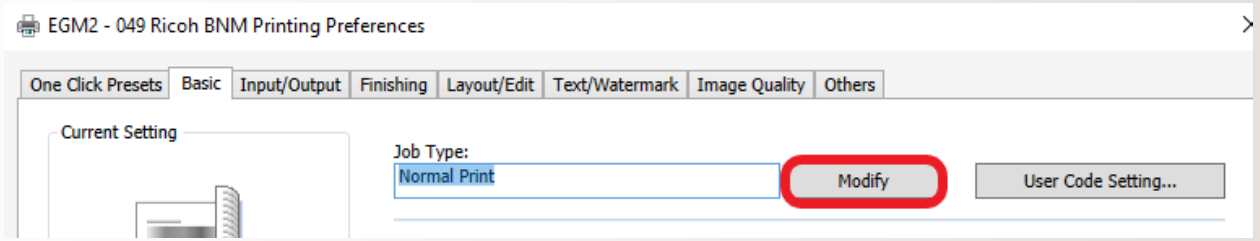
On a tablet / laptop / desktop
- Yes: voice control (*apps, office 365),* mini-keyboard, swipe, …
- But: Keyboard (and mouse) still reigns supreme

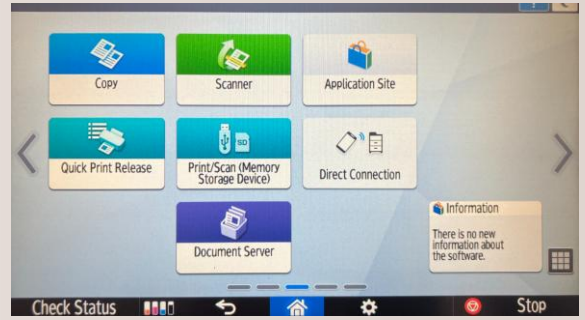
A matter of efficiency / image + avoidable cybersec issues
- *account lock-outs*
- *accidental file deletions*
- *simple passwords (keyboardwalks)*
- *lots of noice…*
- *slow & unproductive*

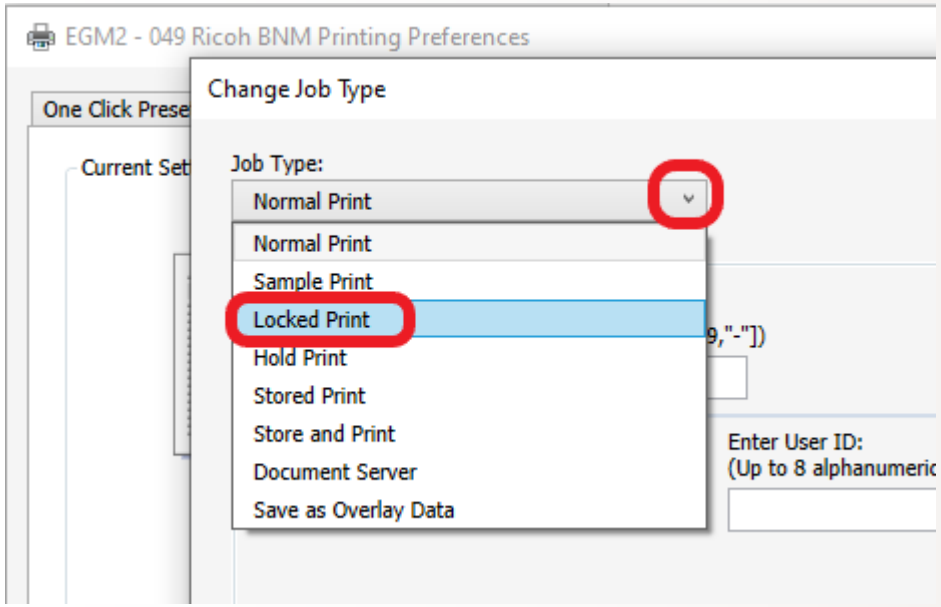
❑ *https://www.typingclub.com/*

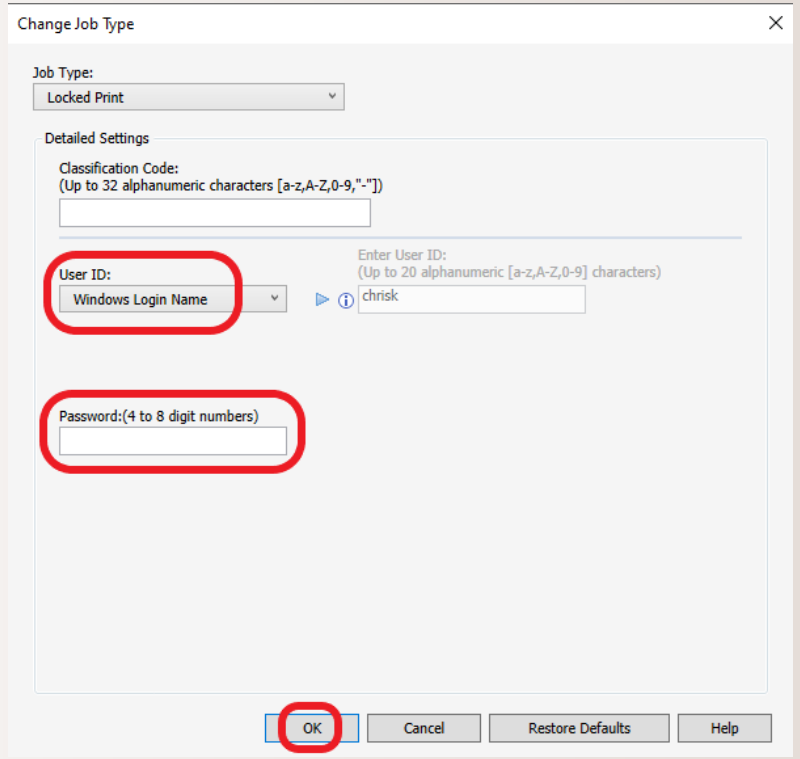
FOUNDATIONS
(data output)

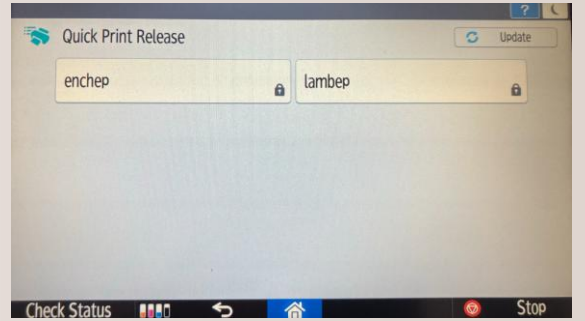


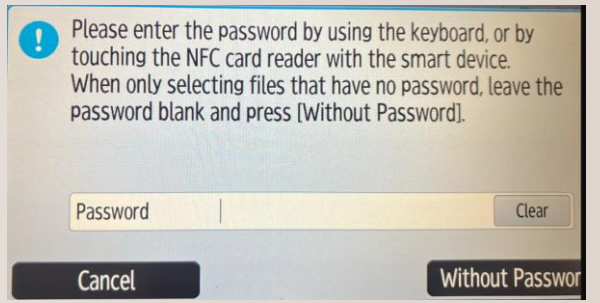






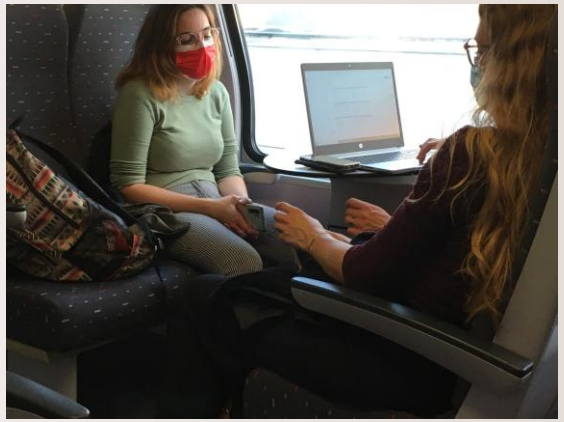


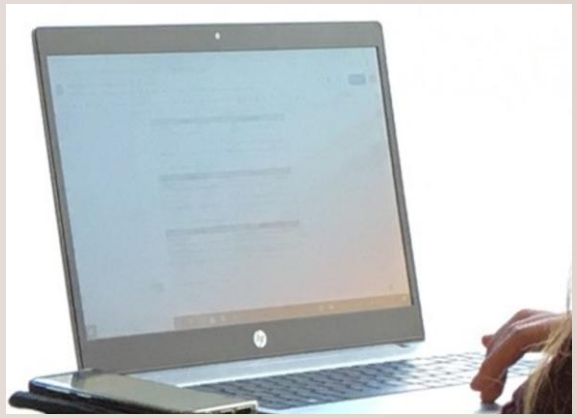




FOUNDATIONS
(privacy screen & cam guard)



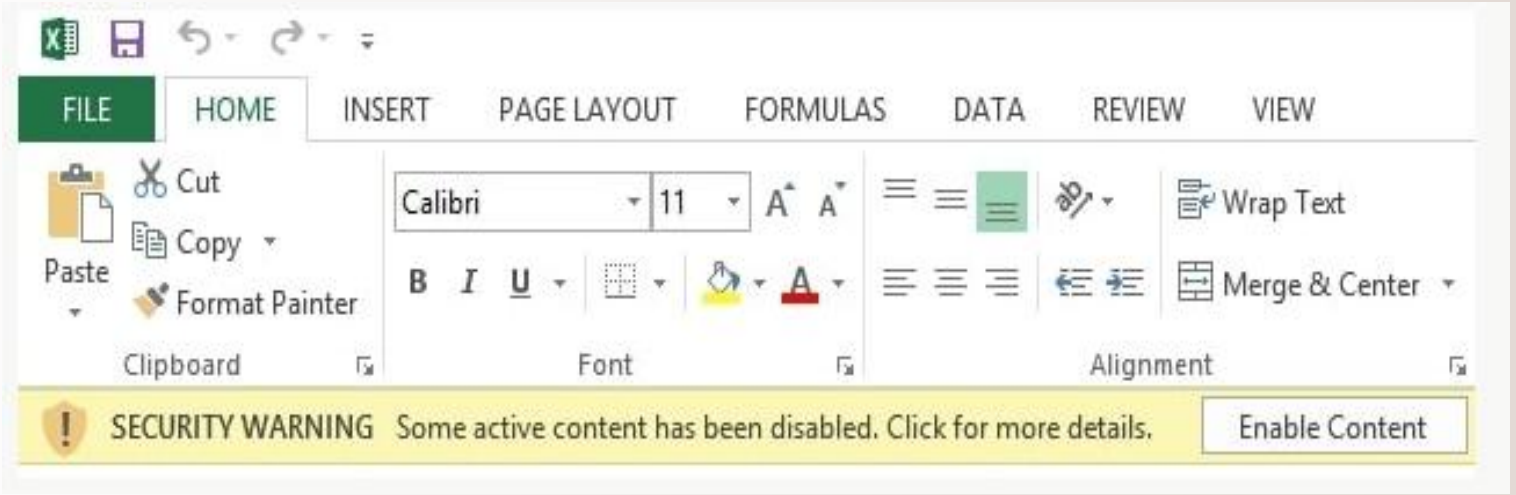


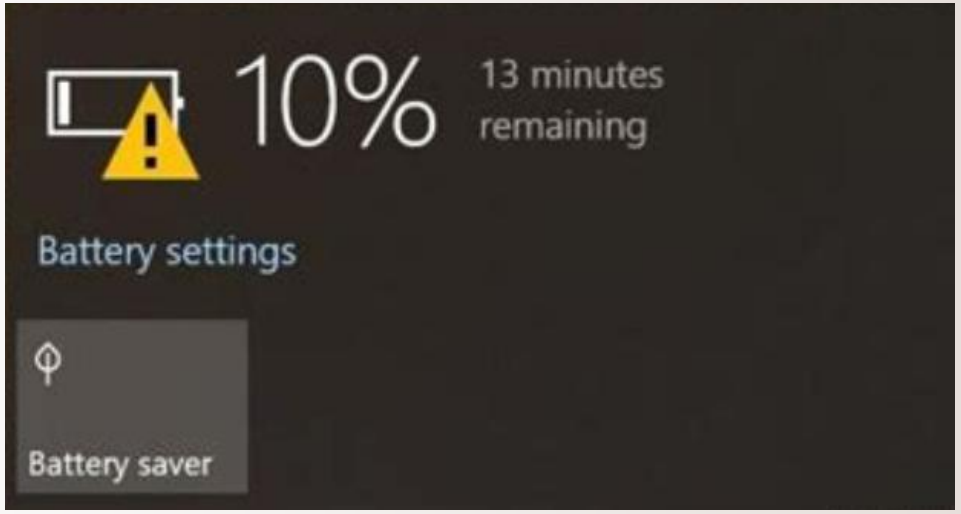




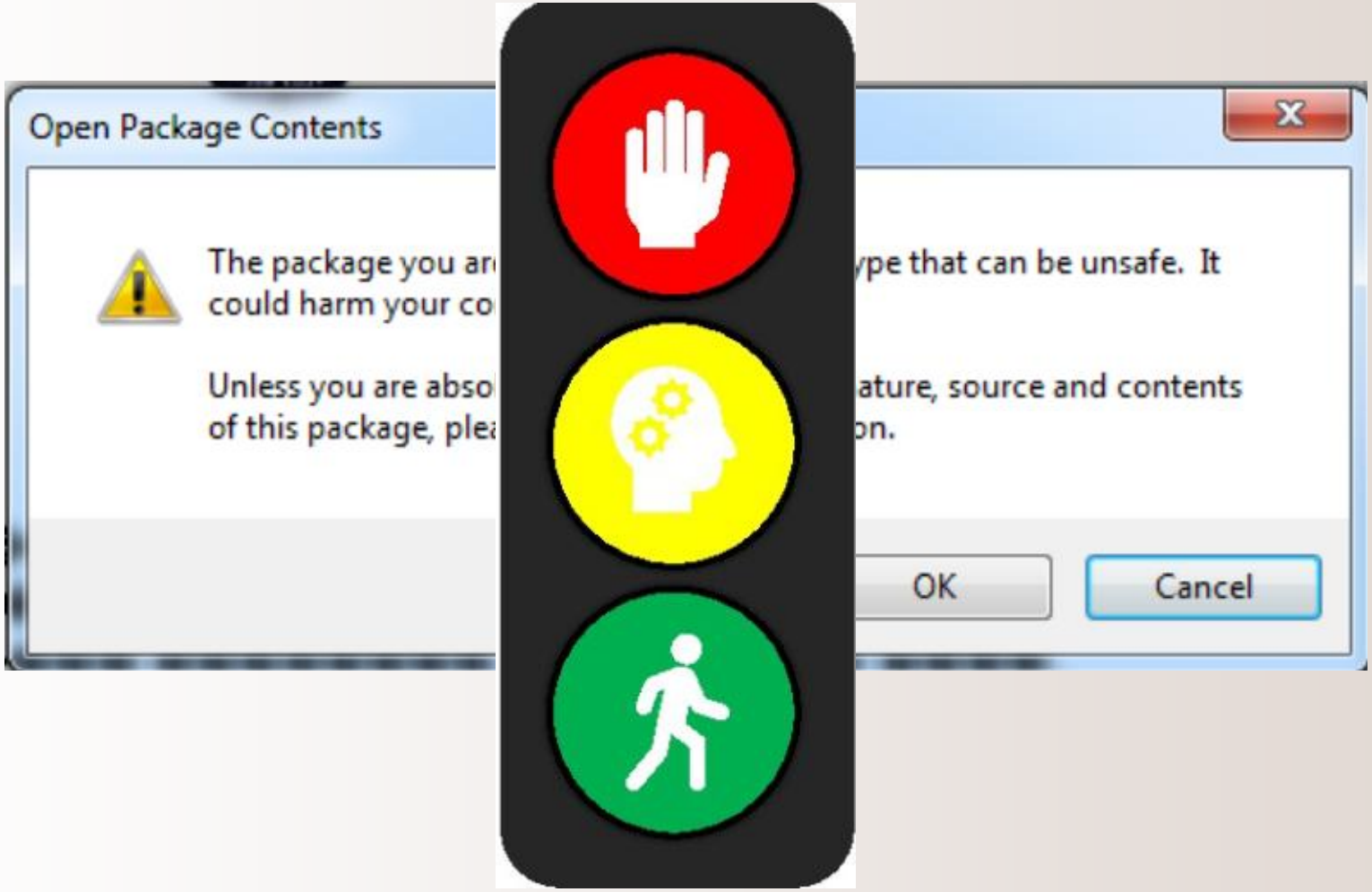


FOUNDATIONS
(common sense)





What would YOU do?



Foundations : *e-mail & authentication*

- **E-mail**
  - 50years & still popular (*to/cc/bcc; attach; urgency; label; revoke…*)
  - Serious security issues *(wrong recipient, wrong attachments, …)*
  - Important attack vector (*advanced phishing-campaigns)*
- **Authentication**
  - Keep it yours: login-pwd/keys/2FA/MFA, …
    (do not let anybody else use it)
  - PWD management : everything you´ve learnt about passwords is (very likely) wrong !

Intermezzo - quick quizz

What´s the strongest password in this list?

1) @levskifan26

2) Xy32%1z?1Ebryt7?

3) Mum just fried me a great 1fish!

4) All similarly strong

What´s the strongest password in this list?

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2) Xy32%1z?1Ebryt7?

3) Mum just fried me a great 1fish!

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What matters most with passwords?

1) The longer my password, the stronger

2) A different password for each application

3) Store passwords in a secure location

4) All of the above answers are correct

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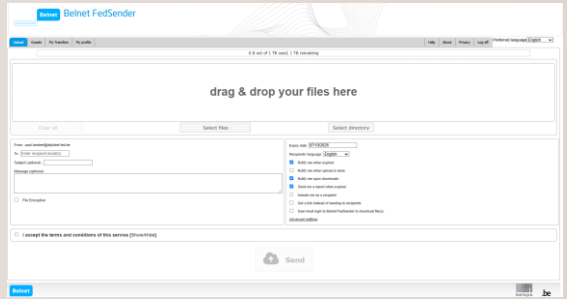
4) All of the above answers are correct

Foundations : *removable media, encryption*

- **AVOID removable media**
  - USB
  - Connected devices (*smartphones, HD/SSD, …*)



- **BUT DO encrypt** :
  - (backup) HD/SSD/USB, smartphone, pwd
  - Your files in the cloud (*someone else's computer*)
  - When transferring files *(example: Belnet Fedsender)*
  - When chatting *(example: BEAM)*
  - DNS *:* 86.54.11.1 (DNS4EU) *rather than 1.1.1.1 or 8.8.8.8*



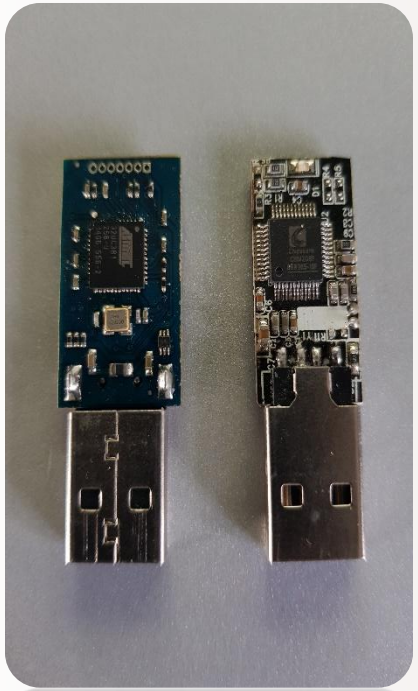
Intermezzo – quick quiz & crypto demo

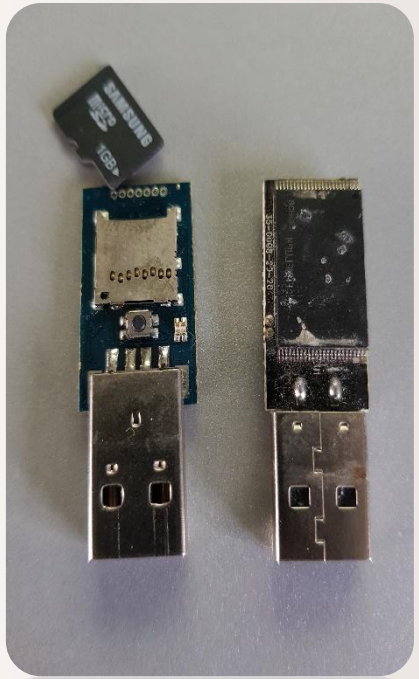
CONNEXUS

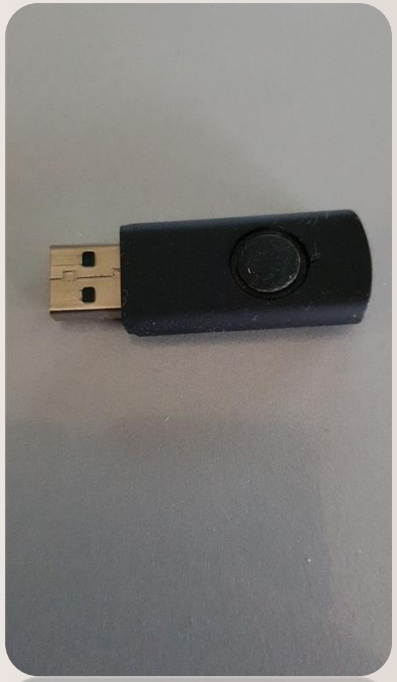
USB: Can you spot the difference?

Rubber Ducky *versus* A Regular USB



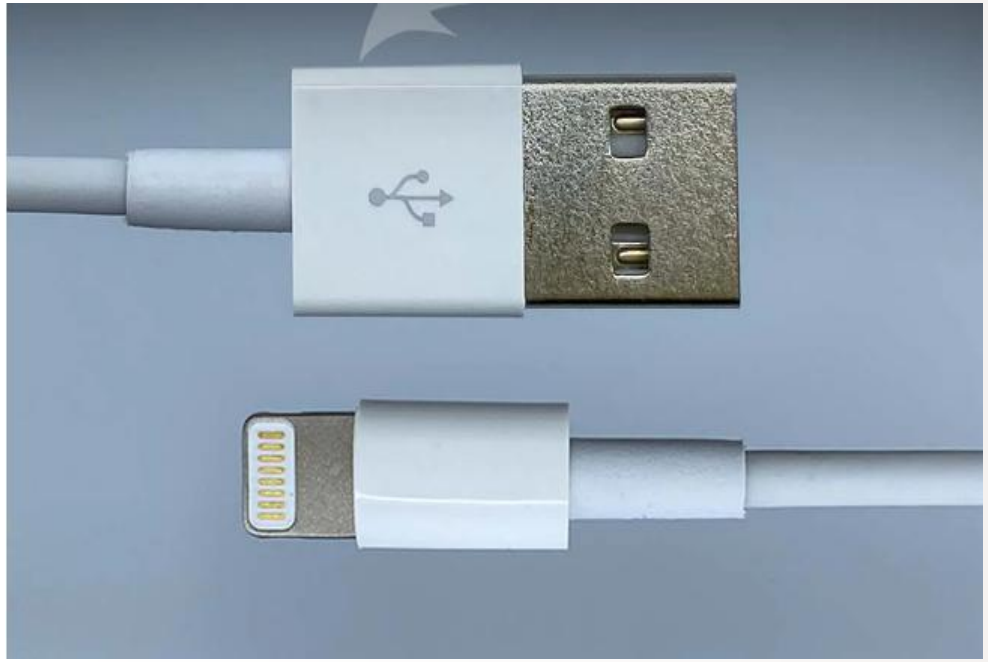








Not just USB keys … also charging cables

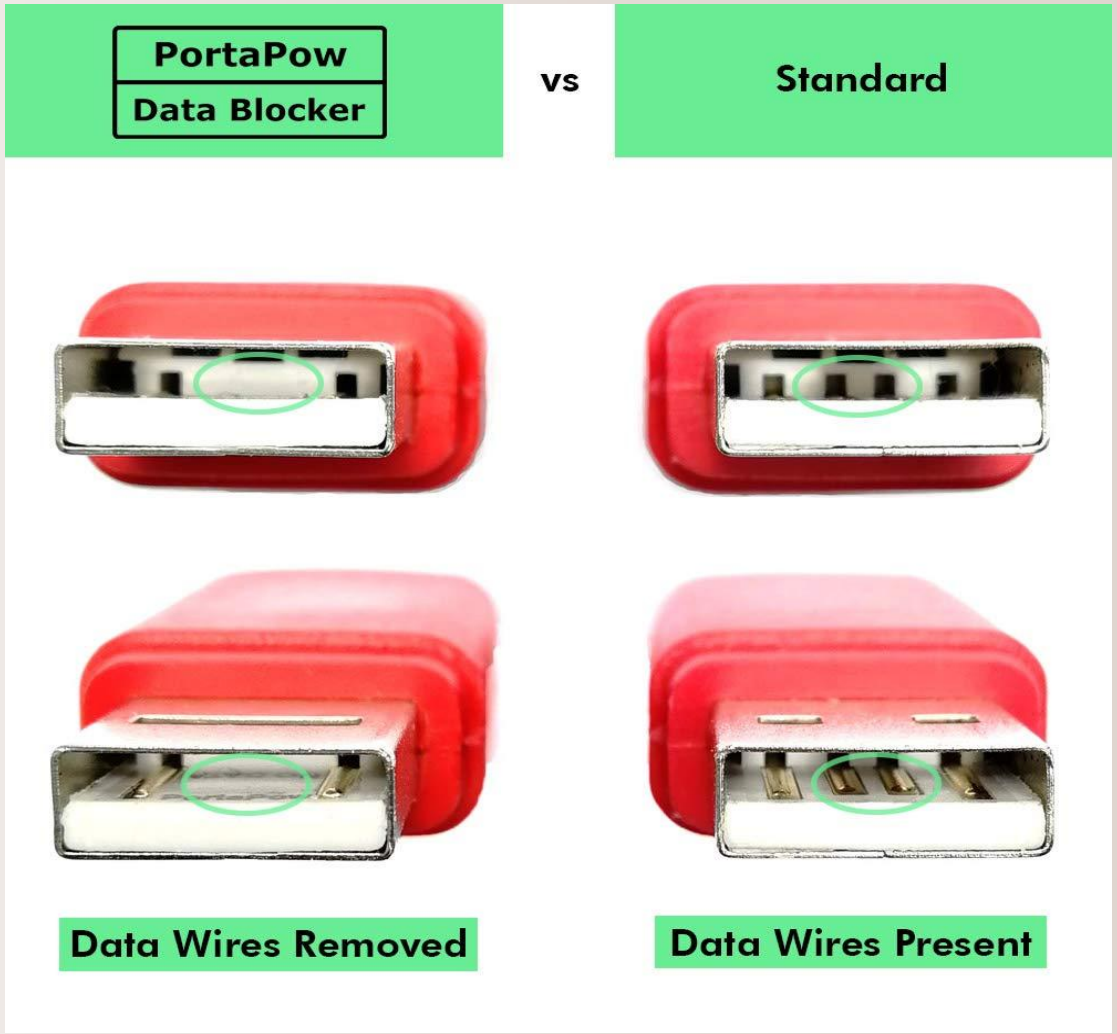


Keystroke Injection (DuckyScript™)	✓	✓	✓
Mouse Injection	✓	✓	✓
Payload Slots	8	8	200*
Self-Destruct	✓	✓	✓
Geo-Fencing	✓	✓	✓
WiFi Triggers	✓	✓	✓
FullSpeed USB Hardware Keylogger		✓	✓
Covert Data Exfil			✓*
Air Gap Comms			✓*
Networked C2			✓*
Extended WiFi range		✓	✓
Stealth-Optimized Power Draw			✓

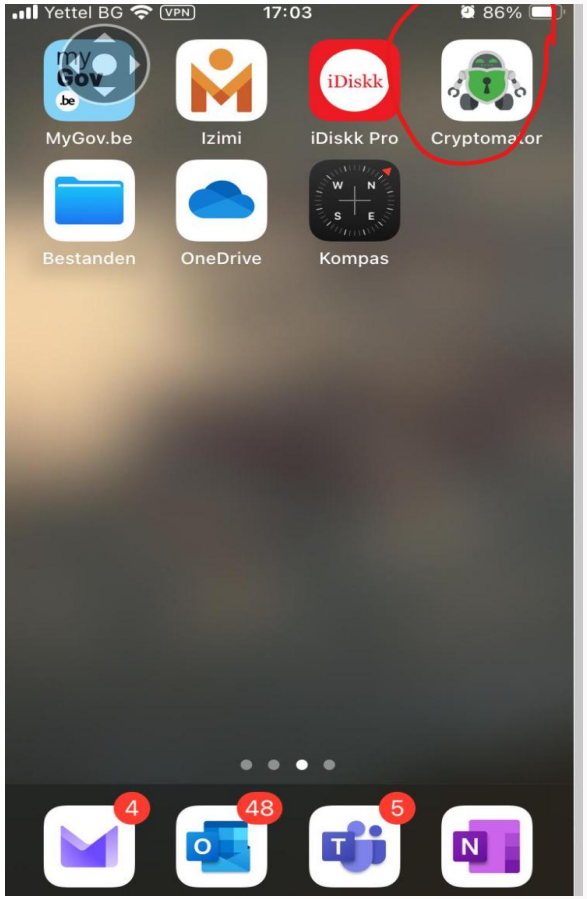
And a remedy: the datablocker

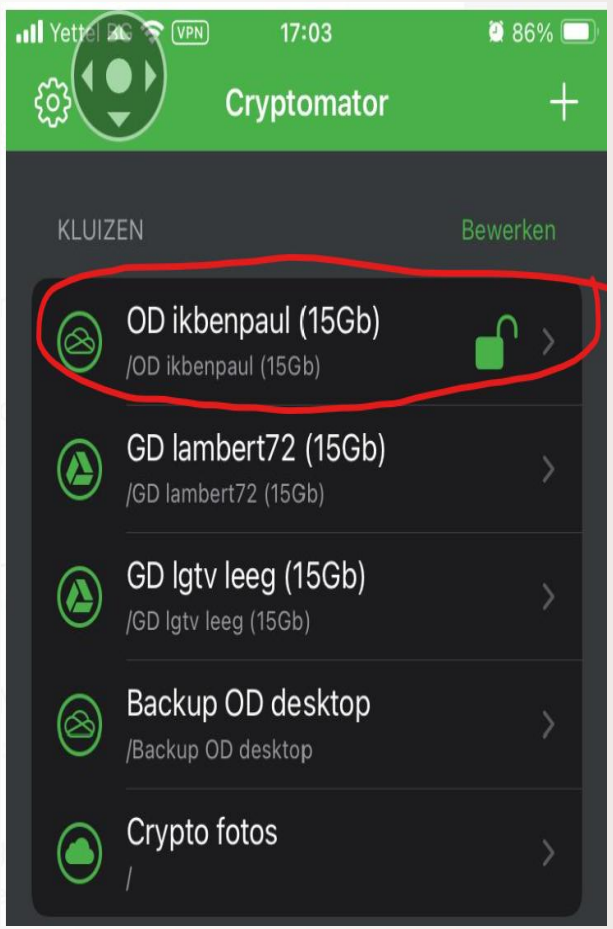
(also known as ….)

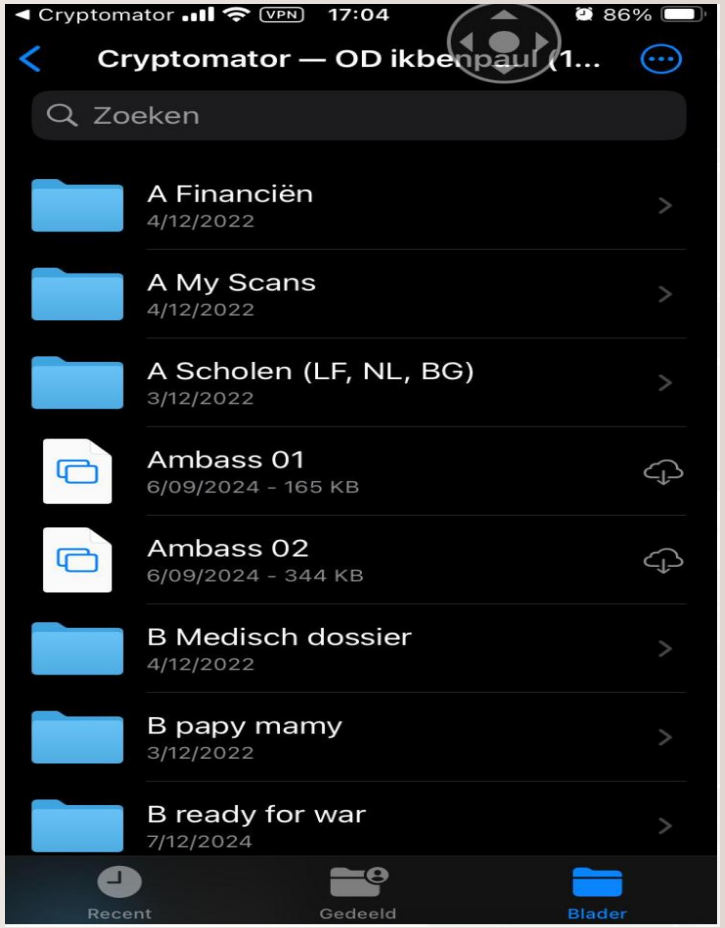




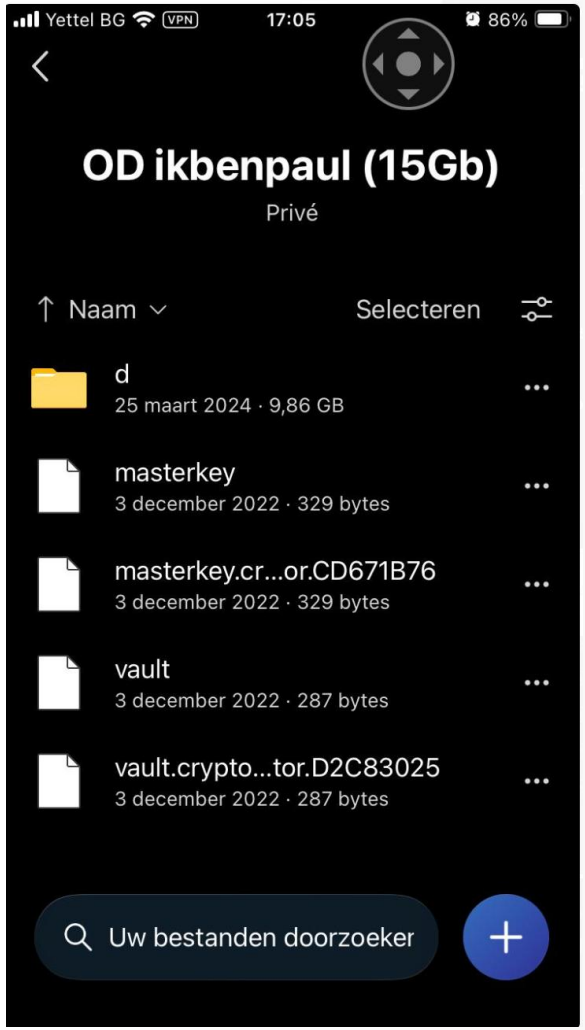
Encryption: Crypto by you ☺

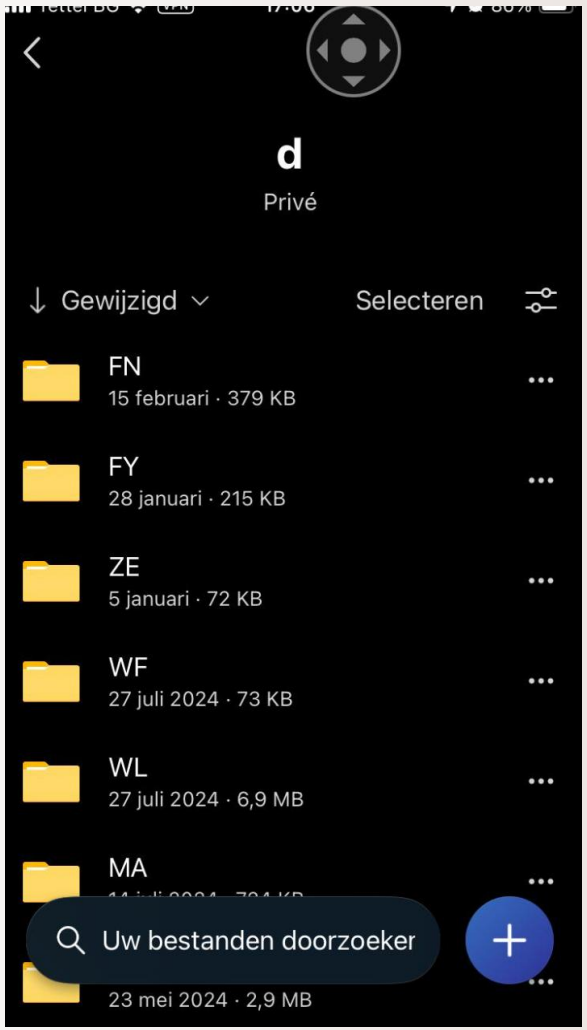






Encryption: Crypto by you ☺

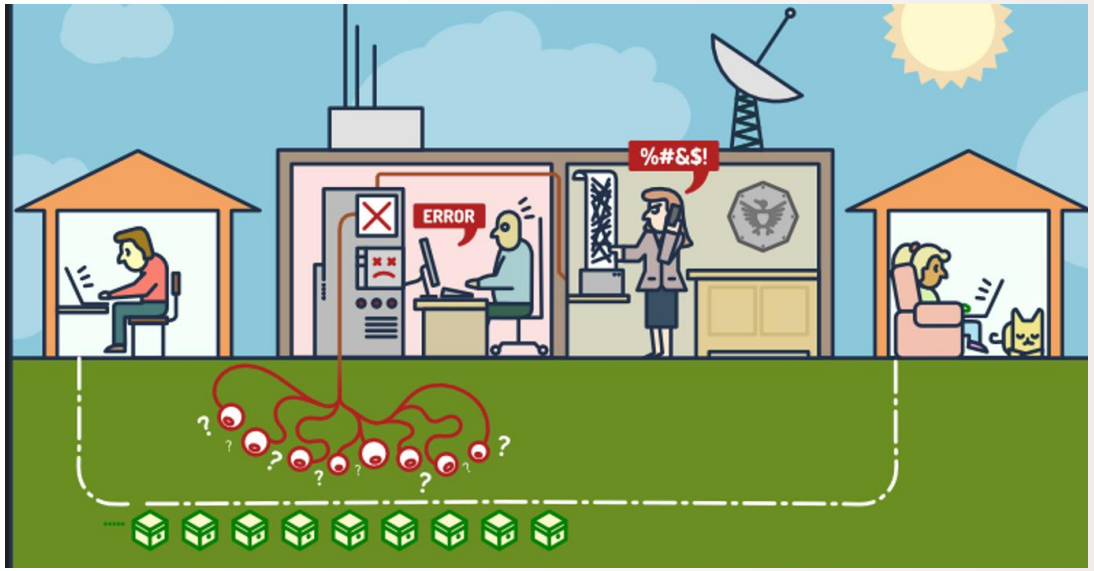




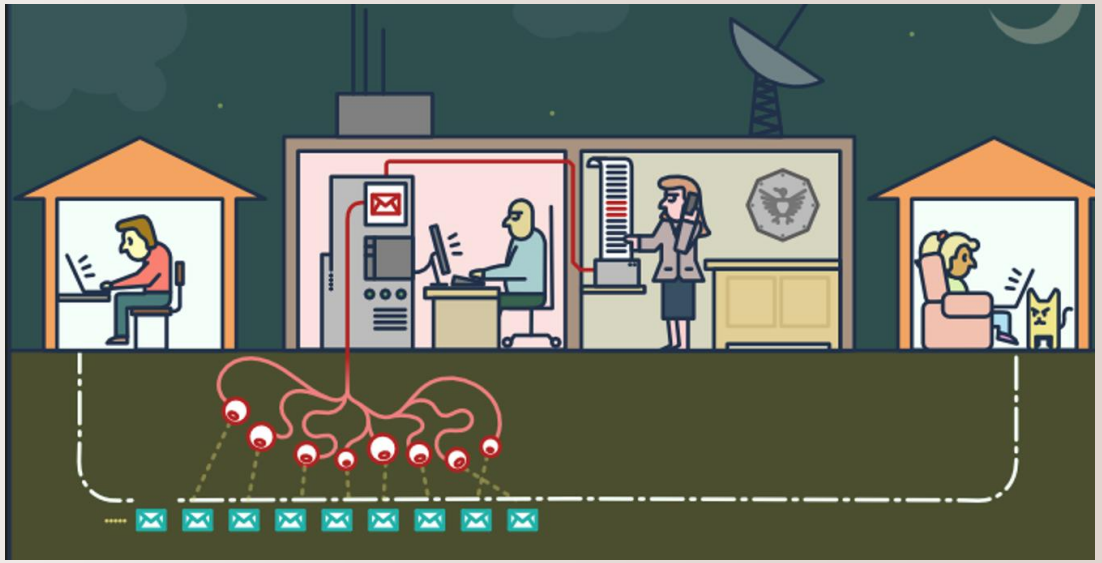


Encryption: why bother?

with encryption
☺ ☺ ☺

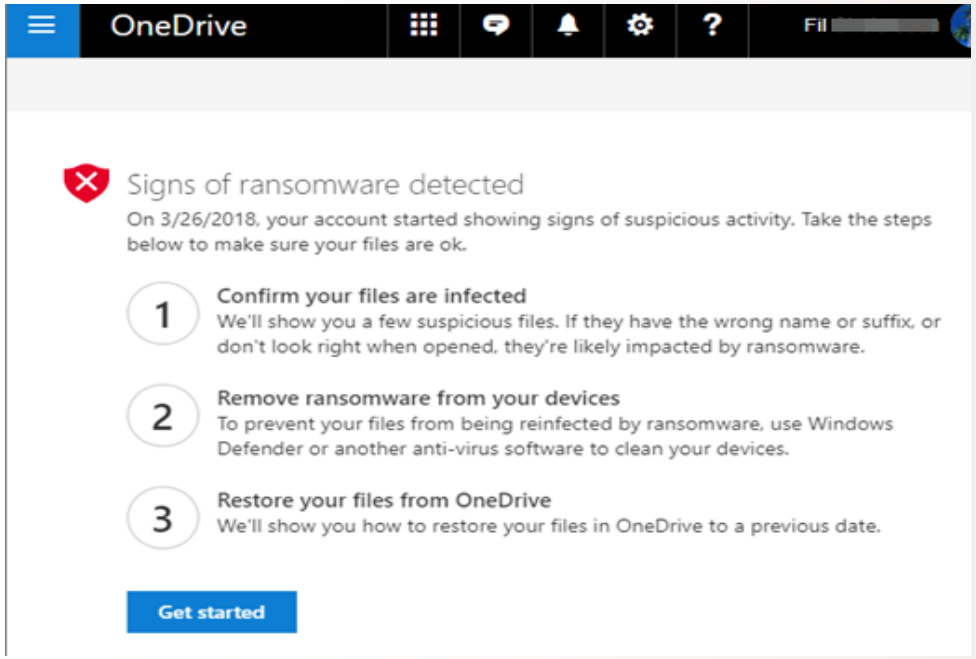


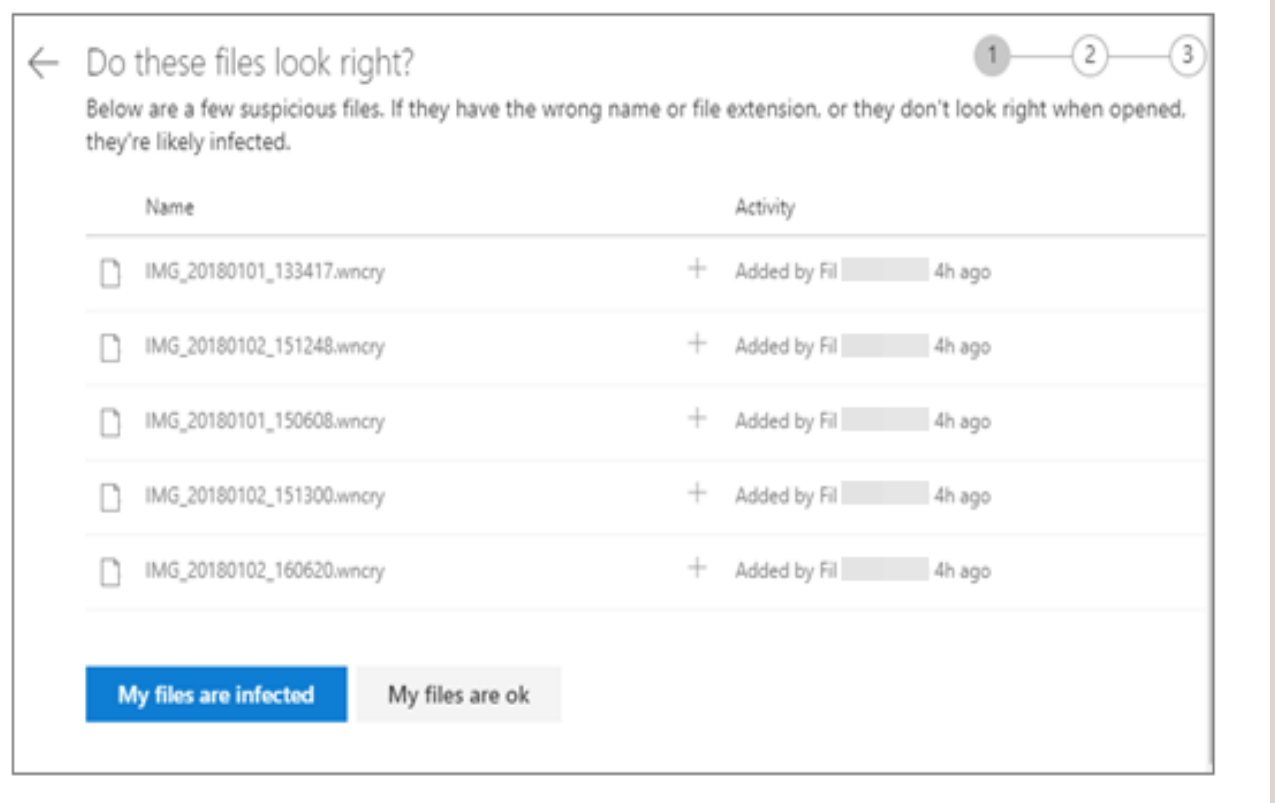
without encryption
☹ ☹ ☹



Encryption: Crypto by you ☺

- Mind the warning!





This indeed looks like ... RANSOMWARE !

Encryption: Crypto NOT by you ☹



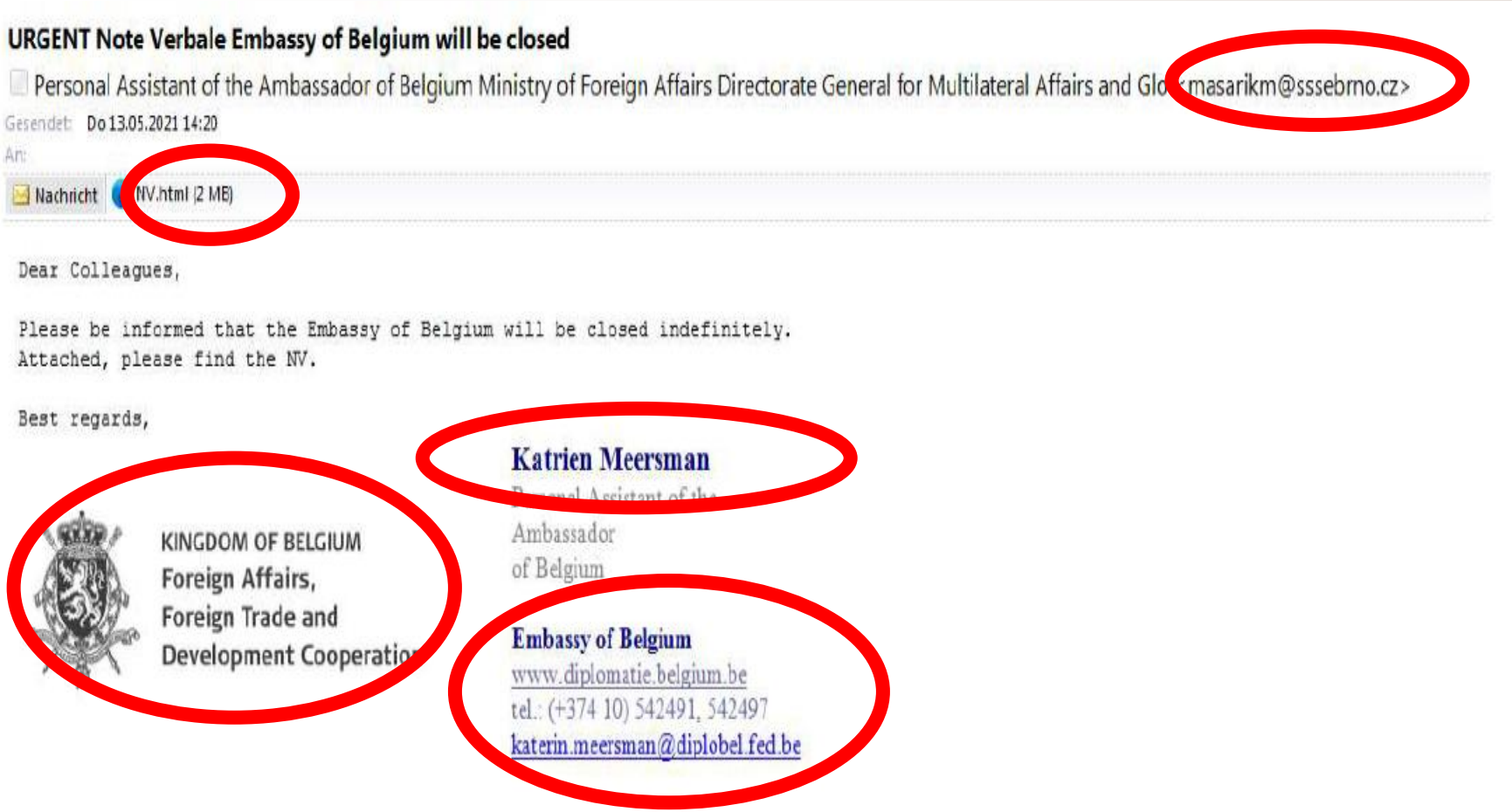
INCIDENTS

(the real thing)



Targeted Incident 1

13.5.2021



- Spoofing
- Impersonification
- Malicious attachment
- Generic e-mail
- *Did you notice?*
- *Timing*

Targeted Incident 2

<Dear Colleague,

On behalf of Germany, France and the United Nations, we have the honour to =
invite you to the High-Level Humanitarian Forum, which will take place from=
10-11 March 2021 in Berlin, Germany.

As a follow-up to the highly successful London World Humanitarian Forum hel=
d in April 2020, the Forum will provide an opportunity for governments, mul=
tilateral and international organizations as well as civil society actors e=
ngaged in humanitarian issues to recommit to addressing the needs and build=
ing the resilience of the over 10 million people still affected by the COVI=
D-19 crisis. The purpose of the Forum will be to galvanize efforts towards =
strengthening humanitarian assistance, resilience, crisis prevention and st=
abilization as well as sustainable development in order to mobilize politic=
al and financial support to enhance cross-border cooperation and tackle the=
crisis.

You are kindly requested to confirm your participation by 26 February 2021,=
using our online registration system. To register, please [redacted] email to
[redacted]forum@auswaertiges-amt[.]de<https://protect2.fireeye.com/v1/[redacted]
=3D6d8b81b9-3210b95b-6d8b317f-86073b36ea28-cdd6d9ade56b2133&q=3D1&e=3Dcf7[redacted]
[redacted]715c-4451-ad87-29bcd92bb0e1&u=3Dhttps%3A%2F%2Fhumanitarian-forum.web[redacted]
pp%2Fmail> upon [redacted] will receive login information to [redacted]
stration system. Attached to this invitation you will find a concept note i=
ncluding a programme outline and a pledging form.

We look forward to welcoming you in Berlin for this important event.

Yours sincerely,

Heiko Maas
Minister of Foreign Affairs
Federal Republic of Germany

Achim Steiner
Administrator
United Nations Development Programme

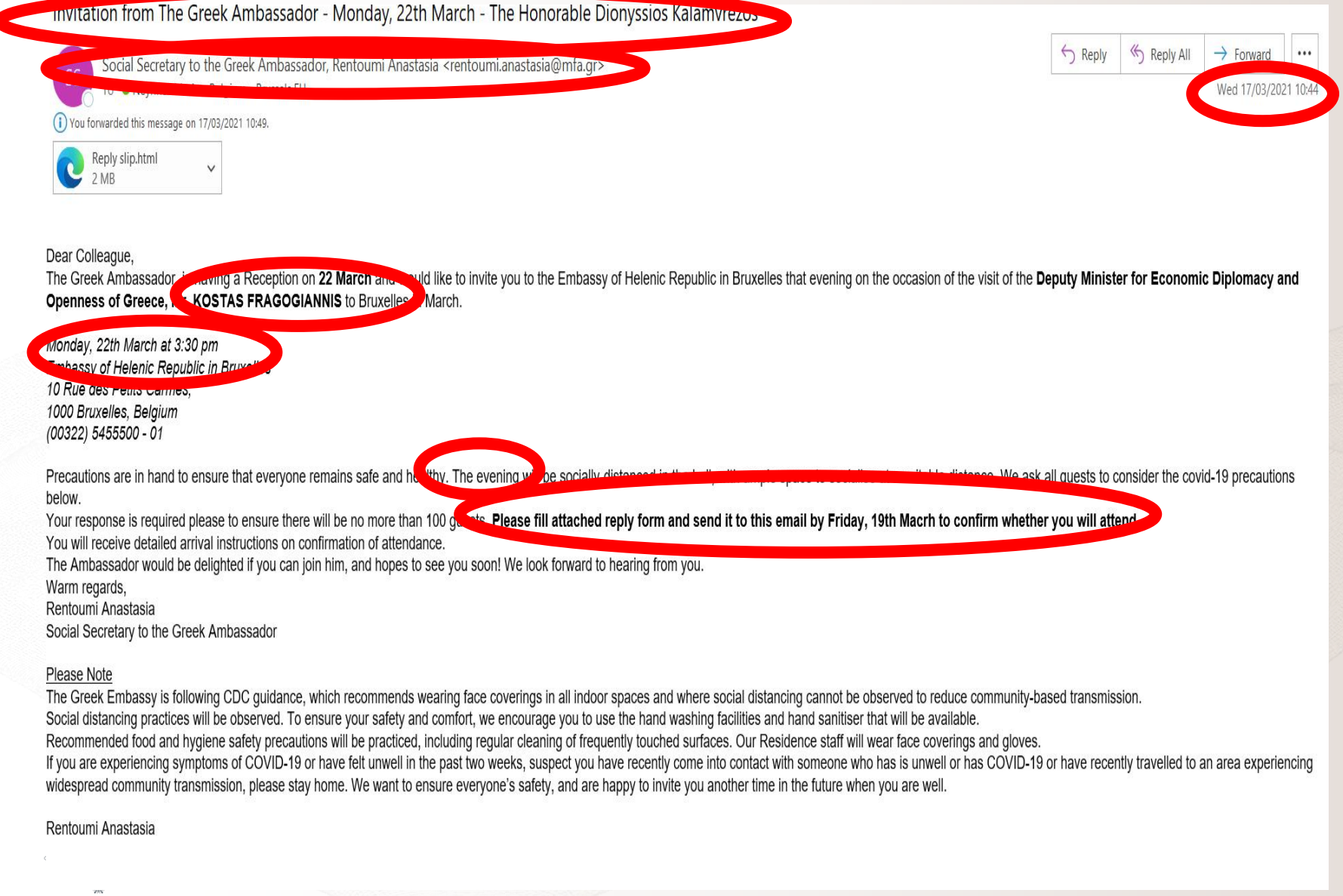
Jean-Yves Le Drian
Minister of Europe and Foreign Affairs
Republic of France

24.2.2021

- Compromised mailserver/box of the Ministry of Culture of a EU Country *(no spoofing)*
- To/cc: Belgian Embassy in Berlin
- Content: invitation on behalf of VIP´s for High-Level Forum in Berlin on 10 - 11 March 2021.
- Urgency: register (*malicious link*) by 26/2 = Friday (reminder: e-mail of 24/2).
- Url-rewriting: tools matter

Targeted Incident 3

17.3.2021



Invitation from The Greek Ambassador - Monday, 22th March - The Honorable Dionyssios Kalamvrezos

Social Secretary to the Greek Ambassador, Rentoumi Anastasia <rentoumi.anastasia@mfa.gr>

Reply | Reply All | Forward | ...

Wed 17/03/2021 10:44

You forwarded this message on 17/03/2021 10:49.

Reply slip.html
2 MB

Dear Colleague,

The Greek Ambassador is having a Reception on **22 March** and would like to invite you to the Embassy of Helenic Republic in Bruxelles that evening on the occasion of the visit of the **Deputy Minister for Economic Diplomacy and Openness of Greece, Mr. KOSTAS FRAGOGIANNIS** to Bruxelles on March.

Monday, 22th March at 3:30 pm
Embassy of Helenic Republic in Bruxelles
10 Rue des Petits Carmes,
1000 Bruxelles, Belgium
(00322) 5455500 - 01

Precautions are in hand to ensure that everyone remains safe and healthy. The evening will be socially distanced in the ballroom with ample space to maintain a comfortable distance. We ask all guests to consider the covid-19 precautions below.

Your response is required please to ensure there will be no more than 100 guests. **Please fill attached reply form and send it to this email by Friday, 19th Macrh to confirm whether you will attend.**

You will receive detailed arrival instructions on confirmation of attendance.

The Ambassador would be delighted if you can join him, and hopes to see you soon! We look forward to hearing from you.

Warm regards,
Rentoumi Anastasia
Social Secretary to the Greek Ambassador

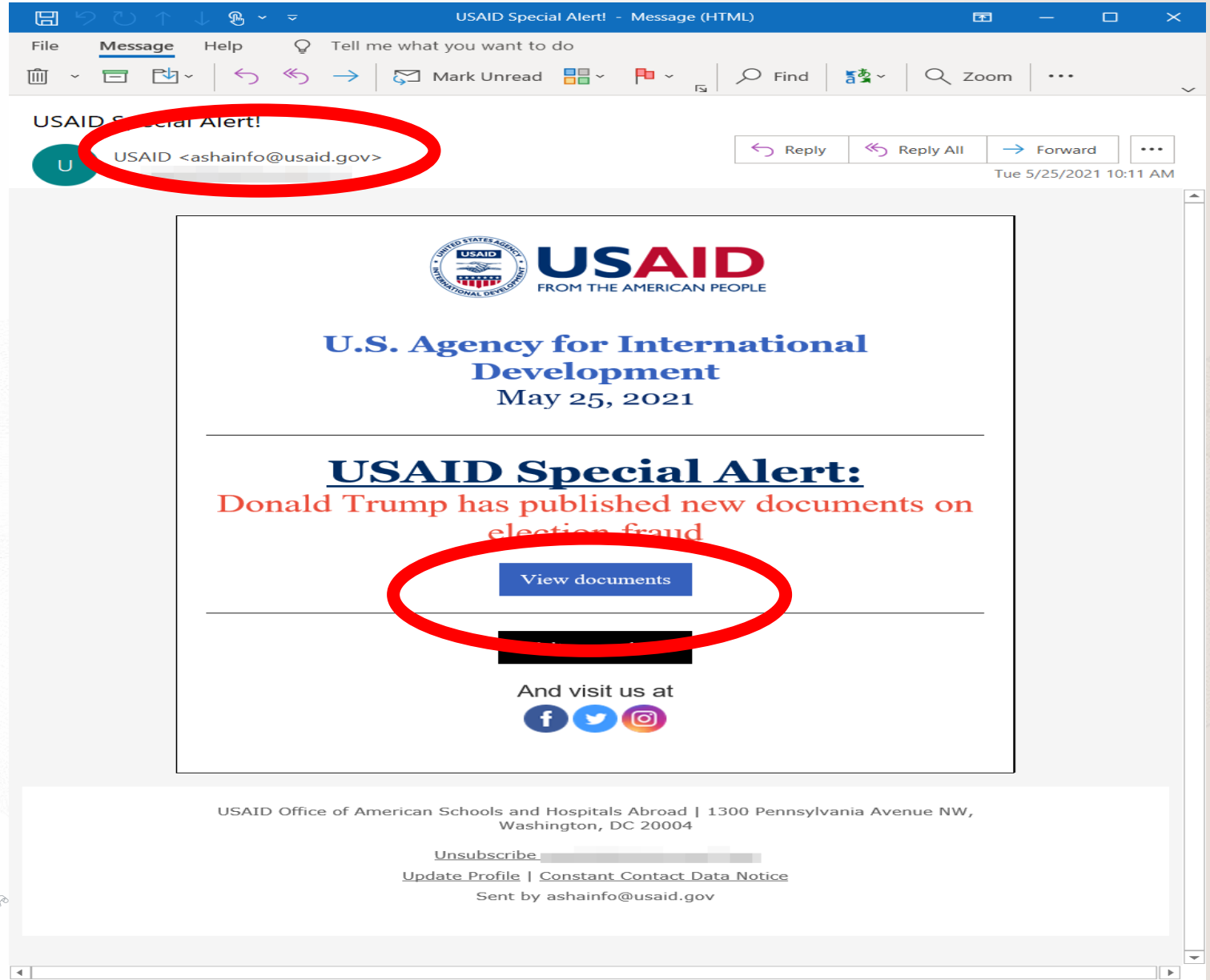
Please Note

The Greek Embassy is following CDC guidance, which recommends wearing face coverings in all indoor spaces and where social distancing cannot be observed to reduce community-based transmission.
Social distancing practices will be observed. To ensure your safety and comfort, we encourage you to use the hand washing facilities and hand sanitiser that will be available.
Recommended food and hygiene safety precautions will be practiced, including regular cleaning of frequently touched surfaces. Our Residence staff will wear face coverings and gloves.
If you are experiencing symptoms of COVID-19 or have felt unwell in the past two weeks, suspect you have recently come into contact with someone who has is unwell or has COVID-19 or have recently travelled to an area experiencing widespread community transmission, please stay home. We want to ensure everyone's safety, and are happy to invite you another time in the future when you are well.

Rentoumi Anastasia

- Compromised mailaccount of a European MoFA *(no spoofing)*
- To: many EU MS
- Content: invitation for High-Level briefing.
- Urgency: register by 19/3 = Friday
- *Did you notice?*
- Timing matters

Targeted Incident 4



25.5.2021

- Compromised mailbox
- USaid: trusted partner of/by DGD (*on mailinglist*)
- Learn & adapt:
  - From junkmail
  - To quarantaine

Targeted Incident 5

13.7.2021

From: Personal Assistant of the Ambassador De Bauw Embassy of Belgium, Ministry of Foreign Affairs <karsten@behrends.at>
Sent: Tuesday, July 13, 2021 5:48 PM
To: Stałe przedstawicielstwo RP przy NATO w Brukseli <bruksela.nato.sekretariat@msz.gov.pl>
Subject: Save the date - Minister's meeting with NATO/EU HoMs

Dear Colleagues,
Dear Defence Attachés,

Would it be possible for you to bring what follows to the attention of your Head of Mission.

Heads of Mission and Defence Attachés are kindly invited to attend an online meeting with Minister for Foreign Affairs and Defence Simon Coveney on Monday 19 July 2021 from 9.30 to 10.30am. Minister Coveney shall give a 20 minute presentation on European security and defence, followed by a 40 minute Q&A session.

I kindly ask you to confirm attendance by **rsvping to myself before Thursday 15 July** to : Jirka.DePaepe@diplobel.fed.be.

Please do not hesitate to come back to me if you have any questions.

The link to the online meeting will be sent to all registered attendees by email a few days ahead of the event.

Wishing you a good day.

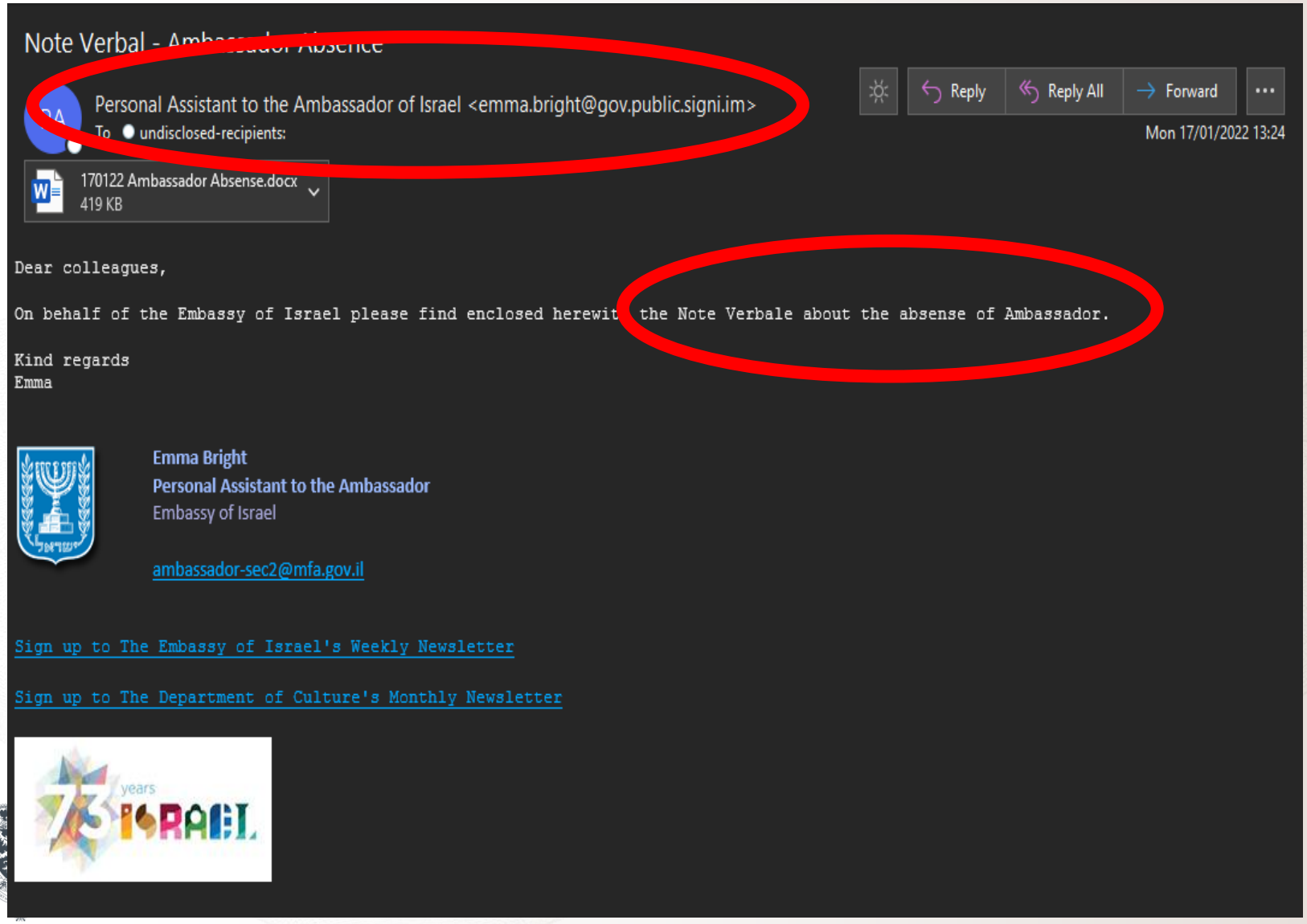
Best regards,

Jirka De Paepe
PA to Ambassador De Bauw
T +353 (0)1 560 0884 www.diplomatie.belgium.be
Embassy of Belgium

Jirka De Paepe
PA to Ambassador De Bauw
T +353 (0)1 660 0884 www.ireland.diplomatie.belgium.be
Embassy of Belgium, 1 Elgin Road, Ballsbridge, Dublin D04 K522, Ireland

- Spoofing
- Impersonification
- NO malicious attachment / link
- On request
- Urgency
- *Did you notice?*

Targeted incident 6



17.1.2022

- Spoofing
- To: BE, Canada, West European countries
- Malicious attachment
- Context UA/RU: *14.1.2022: UA webdefacing*

Did you notice ?

13.5.2021

17.2.2022

URGENT Note Verbale Embassy of Belgium will be closed

[redacted]sador of Belgium Ministry of Foreign Affairs Directorate General for Multilateral Affairs and Glo <masarikm@sssebrno.cz>

Gesendet: Do 13.05.2021 14:20

Nachricht NV.html (2 MB)

Dear Colleagues,

Please be informed that the Embassy of Belgium will be closed indefinitely.
Attached, please find the NV.

Best regards,

Katrien Meersman
Personal Assistant of the
Ambassador
of Belgium

KINGDOM OF BELGIUM
Foreign Affairs,
Foreign Trade and
Development Cooperation

Embassy of Belgium
www.diplomatie.belgium.be
tel.: (+374 10) 542491, 542497
katerin.meersman@diplobel.fed.be

Note Verbal - Ambassador Absence

Personal Assistant to the Ambassador of Israel <emma.bright@gov.public.signi.im>

To undisclosed-recipients:

Reply Reply All ...

Mon 17/01/2022 13:24

170122 Ambassador Absense.docx
419 KB

Dear colleagues,

On behalf of the Embassy of Israel please find enclosed herewith the Note Verbale about the absense of Ambassador.

Kind regards
Emma

Emma Bright
Personal Assistant to the Ambassador
Embassy of Israel

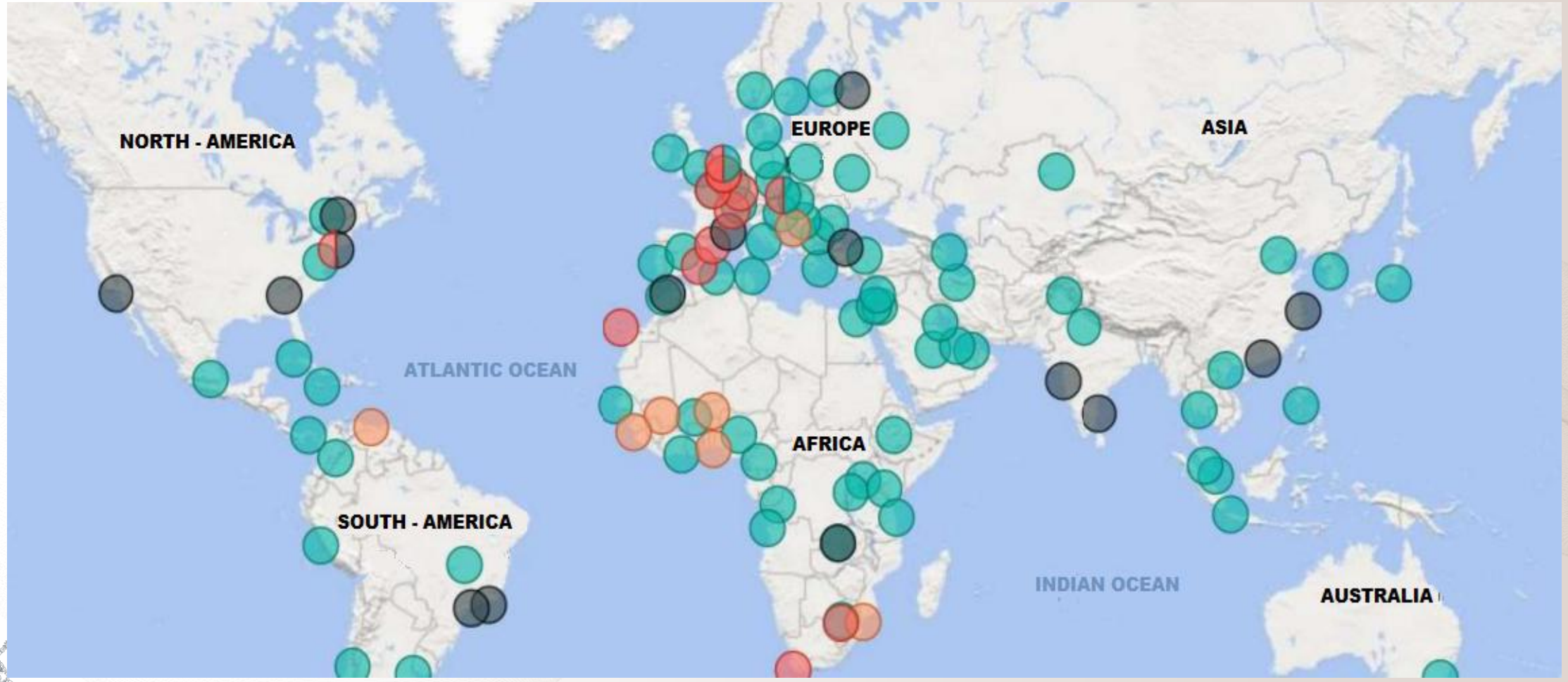
ambassador-sec2@mfa.gov.il

RESPONSES

Tools, training & policy
(all onboard the ship)



Tools: navigating 115 *points of presence*



Tools: securing the E-mail flows

- Various security filters including VPN/Webproxy
- E-mail as important attack vector



Internet

3000 mailboxes

- 100.000 official mails yearly
- Over 3 million e-mails per month

Newsbox

Bannerssites /app

Posters, flyers

Competitions

Infected USB

Quiz Kahoot

hishing sims

April fool

Workshops (« perfect Phishing mail»)

Cyber Night

Summer Playbook

Conferenc

Security Awareness Site

Training* (mandatory)

Table sets

Hacking demo

Screensavers

Cyber Month

Paper Pyramids

Cyber Escape Game

Movie Clips

Online games

Etc.

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China: Declaration by the Minister for Foreign Affairs on behalf of the Belgian Government urging Chinese authorities to take action against malicious cyber activities undertaken by Chinese actors

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Last updated on July 18, 2022

Belgium exposes malicious cyber activities that significantly affected our sovereignty, democracy, security and society at large by targeting the FPS Interior and the Belgian Defence.

Bring cybersec to the coffee/lunch/dinner table!

- Use variety of channels
- **BE** creative: see *ccb.belgium.be/new-cyber-driving-licence-mandatory-all-belgian-internet-users*

Attribution:

- Speak out!

.be

“Never be afraid to ask questions,, because if you never ask, the answer is always no.“

Sheena Yap Chan

